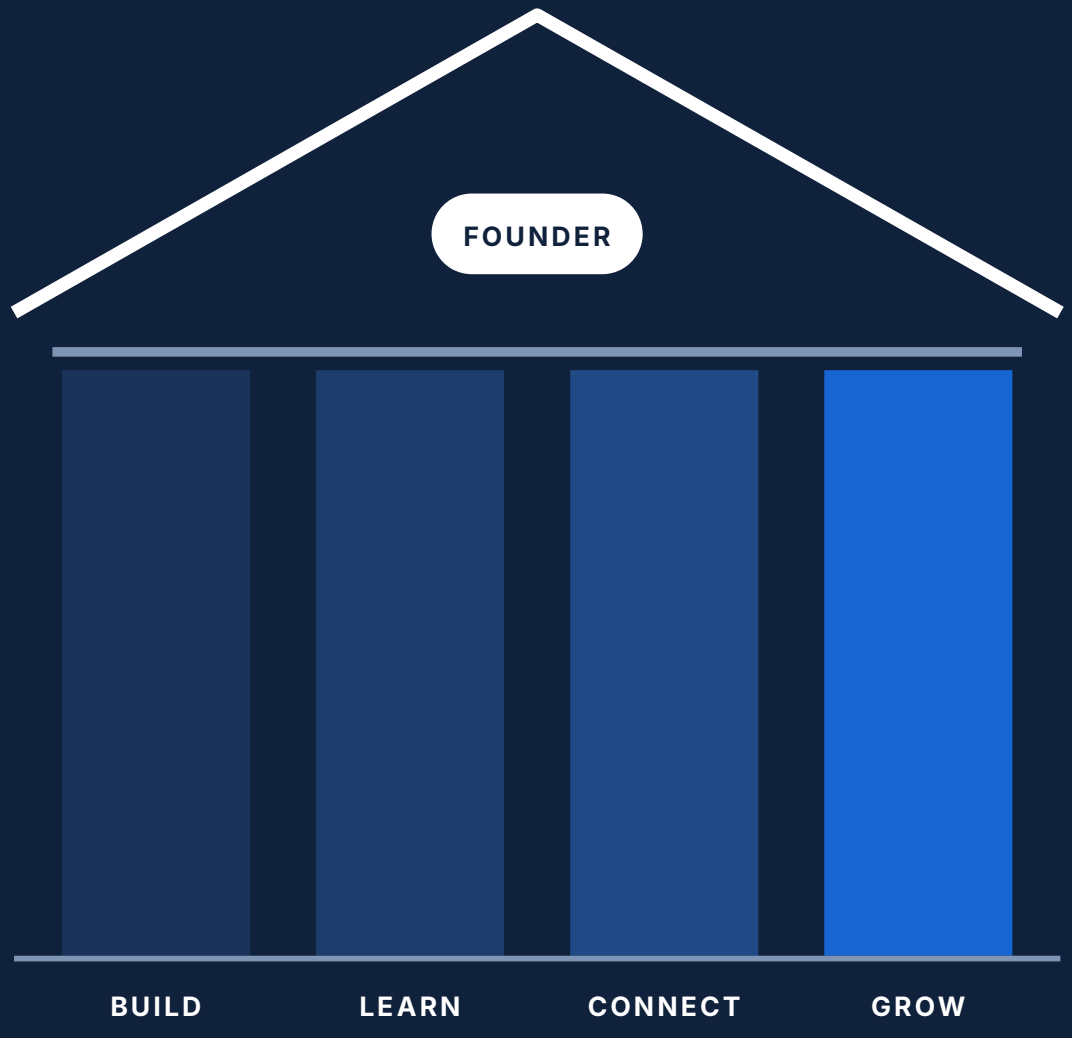
STARTUP ROOF

A FOUNDER ECOSYSTEM · UAE FIRST, GLOBAL AMBITION

STARTUP ROOF

A year-round ecosystem to help founders build, learn, connect and grow.

Home of Founder OS — the digital workspace for the founder journey.



startuproof.com

Founders need more than information. They need a practical path forward.

01 Information is scattered

Guidance sits across many websites, groups and programmes — hard to compare, harder to act on.

02 Tools do not connect

Plans, tasks, documents and contacts live in separate apps with no shared picture of progress.

03 Advice lacks a next step

General advice rarely translates into “what should I do this week?”

04 The right people are hard to find

Relevant mentors and specialists are often reached by chance, not by fit.

05 Introductions go nowhere

Connections are made, but few lead to a conversation with a useful outcome.

06 Time and money are limited

Founders must choose carefully where to spend scarce hours and budget.

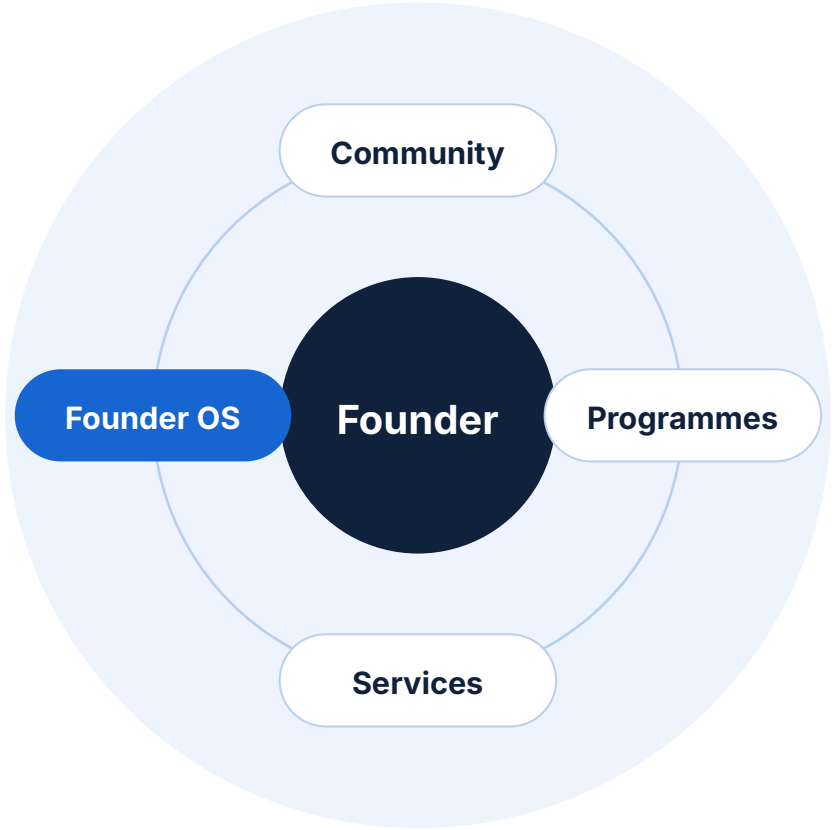
WHAT WE WILL INVESTIGATE

Our working view is that founders move faster when guidance, tools and people are connected to a clear next step.

The pilot will test this directly with founders — through interviews, sessions and follow-up — before we scale anything.

One ecosystem around the founder.

THE STARTUP ROOF ECOSYSTEM



STARTUP ROOF = the wider ecosystem

The community, programmes, relationships and services that surround a founder all year — online and in person.

FOUNDER OS = the digital workspace

The guided online experience inside the ecosystem: a founder's profile, goals, next steps, resources and connections in one place.

In short: an ecosystem around the founder, and a digital workspace for the journey.

Built for founders. Strengthened by the people around them.

PRIMARY · FOUNDERS

Aspiring entrepreneurs

Want to test an idea and understand where to start.

Early-stage founders

Need validation, structure and their first customers.

Founders seeking growth

Need operational support, specialists and sharper go-to-market.

Technology startups and commercially viable businesses in consumer, wellness, retail and services.

SUPPORTING ECOSYSTEM · WHY THEY TAKE PART

Mentors and specialists	Share experience in a structured way and meet founders who fit their expertise.
Investors and angels	Engage with better-prepared founders and follow sectors of interest.
Universities and incubators	Extend support to student and alumni founders beyond a single programme.
Corporate innovation teams	Meet early ventures and run practical challenges or pilots.
Technology and service providers	Offer relevant tools and services to founders who need them.

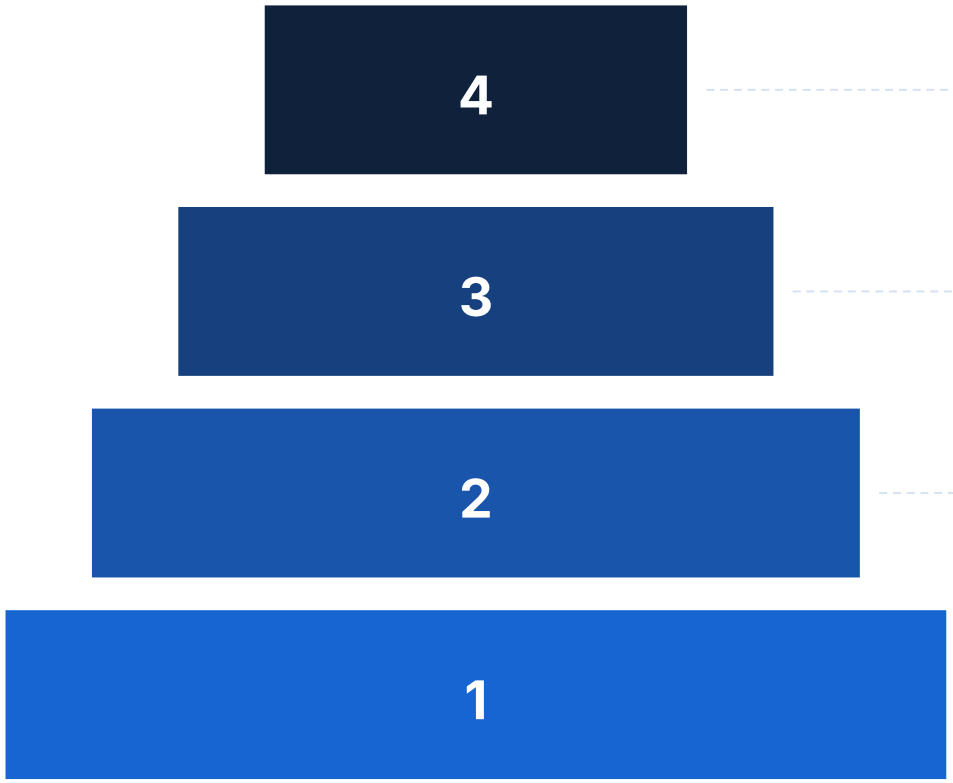
Every founder enters at a different point.

	Explore	Validate	Build	Launch	Grow	Prepare for capital*
Founder question	**Is this idea worth pursuing?**	**Will people actually pay for this?**	**What is the simplest version to offer?**	**How do I reach my first customers?**	**How do I grow without breaking things?**	**Should I raise — and am I ready?**
Support needed	Framing, problem discovery, peer conversation	Interview guides, clinics, mentor feedback	Product, setup, legal and tool guidance	Go-to-market, pricing, brand and sales support	Operations, specialists, systems and hiring	Readiness review, pitch feedback, introductions
Useful next action	Write down the problem and who has it	Speak to 10–20 potential customers	Define a first offer and test it	Run one focused acquisition test	Fix the biggest bottleneck	Decide if external funding fits

Paths differ. Founders join at any stage and may loop back. *Many good businesses grow from revenue and never need external capital — this stage applies only where appropriate.

PROPOSED MODEL

Four layers, from open access to selective support.



Investment connections and future pathways

Investor-readiness support and relevant introductions. Any future investment activity would need its own structure and approvals.

Selective incubation

More intensive support for suitable founders, based on fit, delivery capacity and separately agreed commercial terms.

Paid tools and support

Deeper tools, potential AI-assisted guidance, specialist sessions and structured programmes.

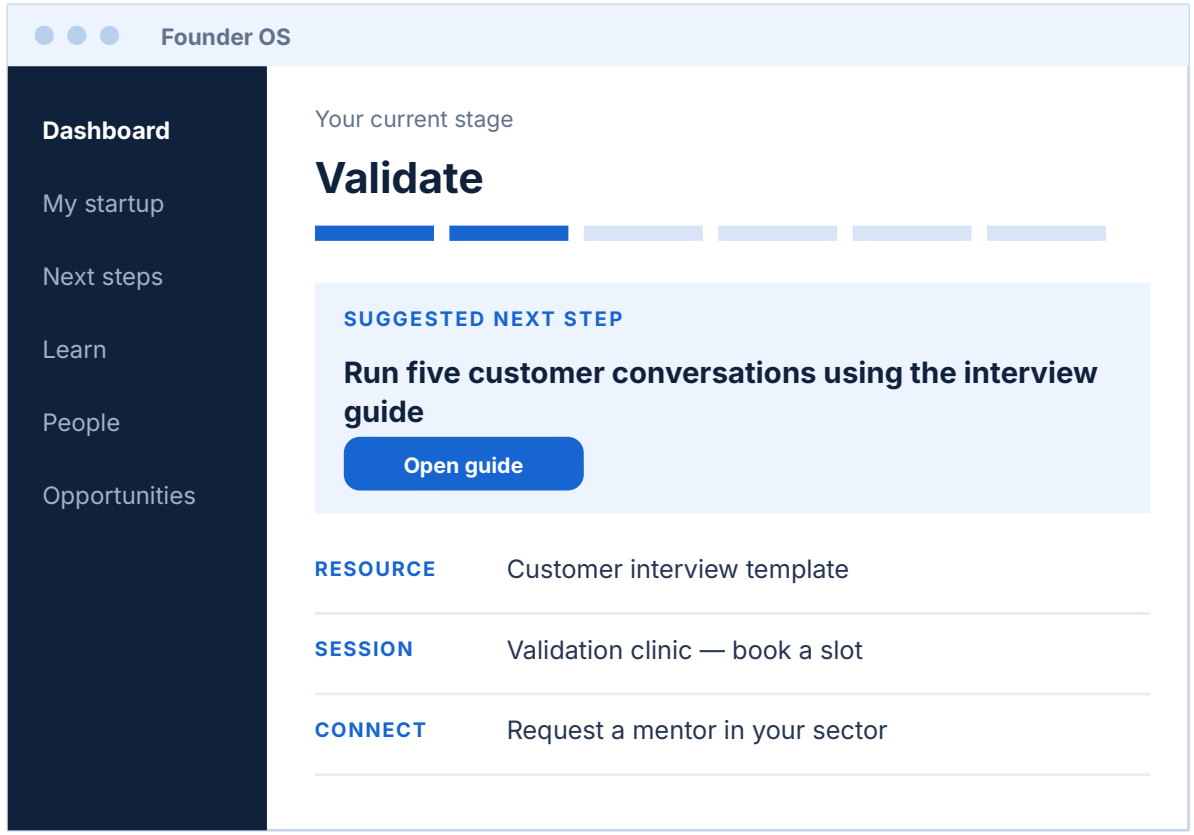
Free founder access

Community, selected resources, discovery and introductory activities — the open front door.

Fewer founders, deeper support, as you move up. Pricing, terms and eligibility will be shaped during the pilot — no fees or equity terms are fixed today.

PLANNED CAPABILITY

A digital workspace for the founder journey.



Illustrative product concept — not a live screen.

1 My startup

Founder profile · stage and goals · personal dashboard

2 Next steps

Tasks · resources and templates · learning progress

3 People and support

Mentor and specialist discovery · connection requests · service requests

4 Opportunities and progress

Relevant opportunities · activity and progress tracking

Capabilities will be prioritised with pilot founders and released step by step.

ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIO

A founder joins with an idea and needs to validate demand.

THE SCENARIO

A first-time founder in Dubai wants to launch a healthy-snack brand. The recipe is ready and the enthusiasm is real, but there is no evidence yet that customers will buy.

This is an example of how the experience is designed to work — not a real customer case.

1

Complete a profile

Stage, sector, goals and time available.

2

Identify the challenge

“I don’t know if anyone will pay for this.”

3

Get a relevant next step

An interview guide and a short validation task.

4

Attend a clinic or ask for help

A group validation clinic or a mentor request.

5

Record progress

Notes from 12 conversations; pricing feedback logged.

6

Return for the next step

Move on to testing a first offer.

PROPOSED APPROACH

Digital guidance, strengthened by human experience.

AI-ASSISTED SUPPORT

Helps founders prepare and keep momentum

- Organising information
- Exploring questions
- Drafting plans
- Suggesting resources
- Tracking next steps

The founder decides

HUMAN SUPPORT

Brings judgement and real-world context

- Mentoring
- Specialist judgement
- Practical feedback
- Complex business decisions
- Sector expertise

Principle: AI prepares, people judge, founders decide. AI features will be tested with pilot founders before release; none is presented here as live.

Relevant connections, measured by what happens next.



How a useful connection is designed to work — each introduction is opt-in on both sides and followed up.

WAYS PEOPLE MAY CONNECT

Founder introductions
matched by need, stage or sector

Office hours
short, bookable time with experts

Small gatherings
in-person meetups in the UAE

Accountability
check-ins on commitments made

Peer groups
small cohorts facing similar problems

Mentor sessions
focused conversations with follow-up

Community discussions
questions answered by peers

PRODUCT PRINCIPLES

Consent first
No introduction without agreement from both sides.

Founder-controlled visibility
Founders choose what their profile shows, and to whom.

Quality over size
We track completed, useful interactions — not directory size.

Practical learning that ends in action.

01 **Idea validation**

02 **Business models**

03 **AI and automation**

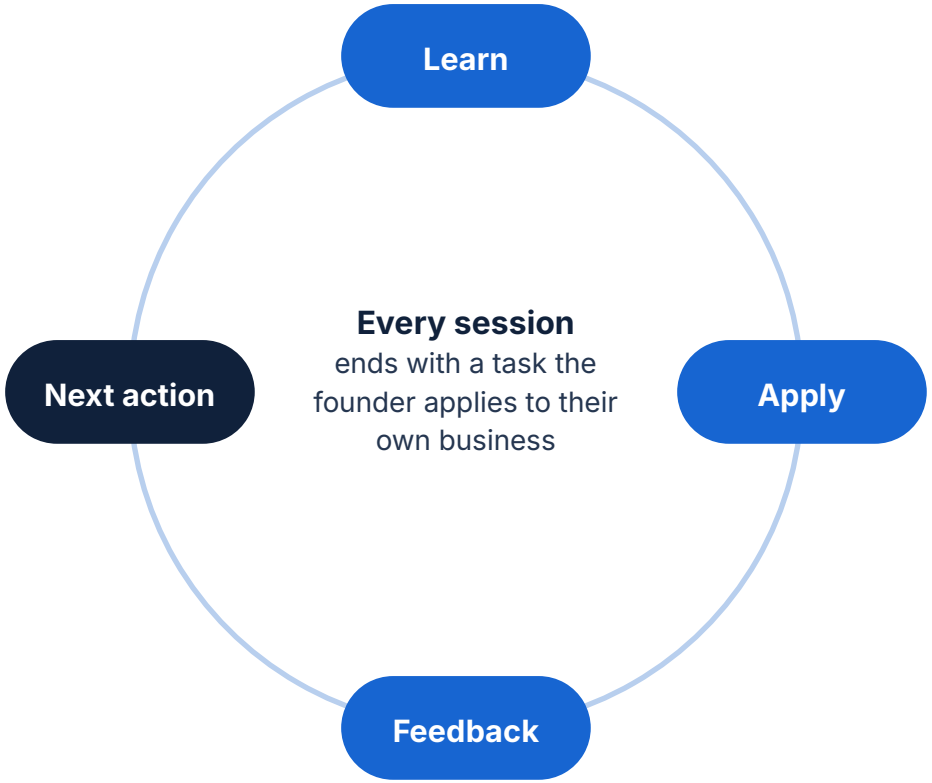
04 **Go-to-market and customer acquisition**

05 **Pricing and unit economics**

06 **Pitch readiness**

07 **Legal and operational foundations**

08 **Consumer-brand and retail development**



Themes are a starting point; sessions and depth will be shaped with founders and contributors during the pilot.

The right specialist or tool, at the right moment.

POTENTIAL SERVICE CATEGORIES

- Legal
- Accounting and finance
- Branding and design
- Technology and automation
- Marketing and sales
- Customer communication
- Business setup
- Product and retail guidance

THREE POSSIBLE DELIVERY ROUTES

Expert sessions

Short clinics and one-to-one sessions with experienced practitioners.

Partner-provided services

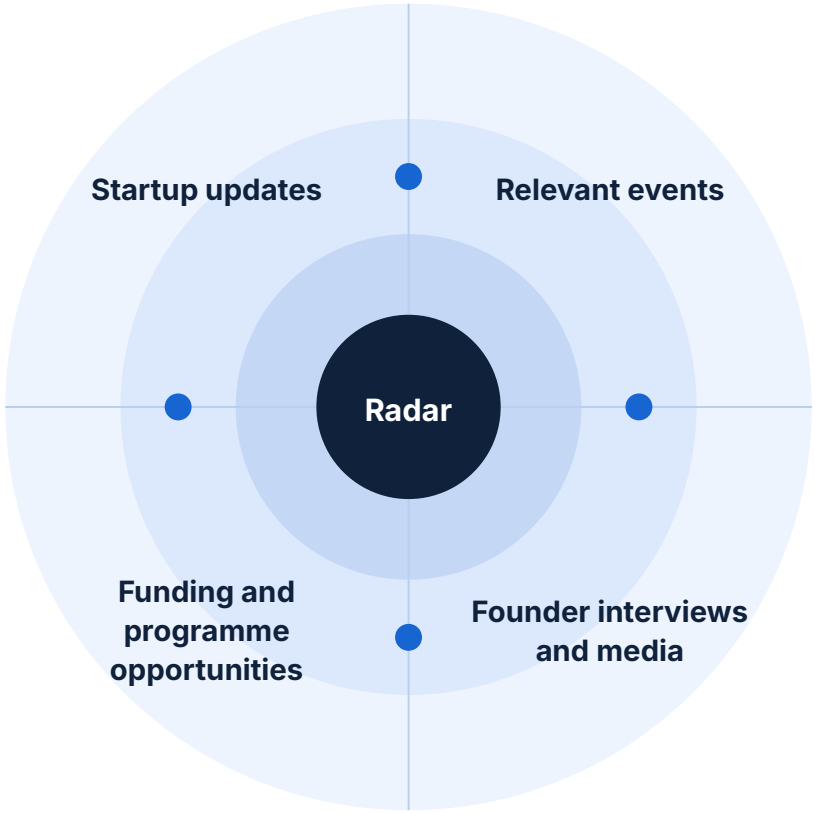
Defined packages from vetted providers, with clear scope before work starts.

Integrated or white-label tools

Useful software inside Founder OS, where commercial rights allow.

Packages, providers, integrations and fulfilment will be validated during the pilot. No supplier is presented here as a confirmed partner.

What matters to a founder this week — with context.



Startup Roof Radar

A planned, curated view of updates, events and opportunities — starting with the UAE and widening over time.

Relevance	Filtered by a founder's stage, sector and location.
Attribution	Every item credits and links to its original source.
Freshness	Dated, and removed when no longer current.
Founder context	A short note on why it matters and what to do next.

Coverage will be selective and grow step by step; it is not intended to be a complete news service.

Selective, structured support where it can make a difference.

1. **Understand the founder's needs**
2. **Assess suitability**
3. **Define a practical support plan**
4. **Match mentors and specialists**
5. **Agree milestones**
6. **Review progress**

Selection point

EXAMPLE SUPPORT PLANS

	Technology startup	Consumer or service business
Typical focus	Product–market fit, early traction, technical choices	Unit economics, channels, supply and operations
Example milestone	First ten paying customers on a defined plan	Margin-positive pilot with one retail or online channel
Typical specialists	Product, AI/automation, go-to-market	Brand, retail, sourcing, finance

Intensive support is selective.

Places depend on fit, the founder's commitment and our delivery capacity. Terms are agreed separately with each business.

Better-prepared founders. More useful conversations.

- **Better founder preparation**
  Founders work through readiness before an introduction.
- **More structured information**
  Consistent profiles, stage and progress — shared with consent.
- **Relevant discovery**
  Filter by sector, stage and geography.
- **Sector-specific engagement**
  Join sessions in areas you know well.
- **More useful introductions**
  Fewer, better-matched conversations.
- **Ongoing ecosystem relationships**
  Stay close to founders and mentors over time.

STARTUP ROOF AIMS TO	STARTUP ROOF DOES NOT
Help founders become investor-ready	Operate its own investment fund today
Make relevant, consented introductions	Promise deal flow, exclusivity or returns
Share structured founder information	Recommend or endorse specific investments
Host sector sessions with investors	Assume every founder should raise capital

Any future investment activity would require its own structure, approvals and terms.

Collaborations that are useful to founders and to partners.

WHY PARTNERS MAY TAKE PART

01 **Reach relevant founders**

02 **Deliver education or specialist support**

03 **Test useful services**

04 **Build long-term relationships**

05 **Support entrepreneurship programmes**

06 **Explore commercial distribution**

COLLABORATION FORMAT	SUITS	WHAT IT COULD LOOK LIKE
Workshops	Specialists, firms	A practical 90-minute session on a founder topic
Office hours	Mentors, advisers	Regular bookable slots with short follow-up
University programmes	Universities, incubators	Support for student and alumni founders
Tool or service pilots	Technology and service providers	A limited trial with feedback from founders
Community activities	Corporates, venues	Hosting a meetup or a themed founder evening
Content collaboration	Media, experts	Guides, interviews or co-created resources

These are possible formats to explore together; no partnerships are presented here as signed.

Free access can create reach.
Useful services must create sustainable value.

Free access

Community, resources and discovery build reach and trust.

Optional paid value

Founders and partners pay only for what is clearly useful.

Delivery costs

Expert time, platform, events and support all have real costs.

Unit economics

To validate: each service must cover its costs and contribute to the whole.

REVENUE HYPOTHESES TO TEST

- Paid memberships or tools
- Specialist support packages
- Structured programmes
- Partner and service revenue arrangements
- Corporate or university programmes
- Sponsorship of suitable activities
- Selective incubation arrangements, where separately agreed

No financial forecast is presented. Pricing and margins will be tested in the pilot before any are published.

Shape, test, then expand what works.

NOW Shape and test

- Founder interviews
- Participant contributions
- Service selection
- Platform requirements

NEXT Deliver a small pilot

- Useful sessions
- Onboarding and follow-up
- Growth experiments
- Measure delivery costs

THEN Expand what works

- Repeat strong services
- Improve the platform
- Formalise responsibilities
- Build partnerships

MILESTONES WE ARE WORKING TOWARDS

10,000 free users

Threshold for a public launch event

March 2027 tentative

Target timing, subject to readiness

100,000 free users

Wider, longer-term ambition

Targets and timing will be refined through the pilot. These are ambitions, not current traction.

Bringing complementary experience together.

STRATEGY AND COMMERCIAL

- Commercial leadership
- GTM and customer lifecycle
- Legal and governance

FOUNDER SUPPORT

- Startup and incubation experience
- Consumer-business mentoring
- Education and university outreach

PLATFORM AND GROWTH

- AI and business systems
- Branding and growth

COMMUNITY AND DELIVERY

- Operations and community
- Events and experiences

We are exploring how like-minded contributors can participate through their experience, resources and available time.

HOW ROLES WILL TAKE SHAPE

Longer-term roles and responsibilities will be considered as the project develops, based on contribution, time commitment, responsibility taken, reliable delivery and value created.

Ritesh Kumar
Project Initiator

Help shape a practical ecosystem for the founder journey.

Founders	Help shape the platform and express interest in the pilot.
Mentors and specialists	Contribute expertise and practical sessions.
Partners and universities	Explore a useful collaboration.
Investors	Connect around founder readiness and ecosystem opportunities.
Prospective collaborators	Discuss how your skills and time can contribute.

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Scan to visit the website and get in touch.